

Book launch draws crowd in Thompson



Mayor Bill Comaskey cuts the ribbon with Sukh Khokhar, executive director of the Multi Culture Centre, during the book launching ceremony at city hall Wednesday night. The Multi Culture Centre also launched its website, www.mysterynet.mb.ca/tmc.

By Catherine Watters

The Multi Culture Centre officially launched its book, *The Many Faces of Discrimination in Northern Manitoba*, at City Hall Wednesday night. There were about 40 people in attendance.

Graham Buckingham, a man who wears many hats, was the first to speak. He is the president of the Thompson Citizenship Committee, a parent organization of the Multi Culture Centre.

He is also the chair of the Race Relations Committee (RRC), which was formed in 1990, a city councillor and school board trustee.

"Thompson, as always, is ahead of the pack," he said, noting that while the rest of the world has one day to celebrate the International Day for the Elimination of Racism, March 21, the City of Thompson has a full week.

Mayor Bill Comaskey said it was good to see so many people out for this event, which was held in council chambers. When

Comaskey was originally elected to city council in 1989, he and others, including Sukh Khokhar, the director of the Multi Culture Centre, started working on the Race Relations Committee for Thompson.

"Thompson is a unique place to live," said Comaskey. "It's a great place to raise a family."

He thanked the people involved with the RRC, especially Buckingham.

"He's done a great job with the Race Relations Committee...and

has been important in the growth of the committee."

He also thanked the RCMP for their participation, Khokhar for her support, and others.

"The book is not an easy read," said Comaskey. "We don't want to ignore that there are problems in terms of race relations." Instead, he said, we want to become aware of what the problems are and learn from it, to find ways to deal with these problems.

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